

# PPC Samurai: Driving effective search campaigns automation on Google Cloud

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ABOUT PPC SAMURAI

PPC Samurai helps agencies save time managing search campaigns with its workflow automation application on Google Kubernetes Engine and performance data on Cloud SQL.



## About PPC Samurai

Founded in 2013, PPC Samurai was a digital agency that created its patented flowchart technology as an internal tool to drive efficiency. However, the company soon gathered interest from other digital agencies who wanted to automate workflows and optimize PPC campaigns at scale, without writing code. PPC Samurai thus pivoted from a digital agency to a software company in 2015 to offer its PPC management suite to PPC experts, anywhere in the world. The company has received accolades such as becoming the APAC 2021 Search

## Google Cloud results

- Able to respond quickly to meet business needs with on-demand cloud resources, instead of taking two weeks to provision a new physical server
- Improves PPC workflow automation for digital agencies by speeding up app performance from 400 milliseconds to 200 milliseconds
- Reduces 50% of CPUs

## Exceeded expectations for PPC application

Awards Winner, European 2021 Search awards finalist, and UK 2020 Search awards finalist for its marketing automation platform. PPC Samurai gives back to the community through pro bono work for non-profit organizations and volunteer leave for employees.

Industries: Technology

Location: Australia

<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>



## About DoiT International

Founded in 2011, DoiT International operates in nearly 70 countries, including the United States, United Kingdom, Germany, France, Australia, and Israel. The Google Cloud strategic partner is a leading global cloud consulting company that provides multi-cloud expertise, proprietary cloud optimization and governance software, helping customers tackle complex problems at scale.

Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)

Cloud Load Balancing  
(<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>)

Cloud SQL (<https://cloud.google.com/sql/>)

required for  
worst  
performing  
queries  
using Cloud  
SQL Insights

Kubernetes Engine

(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>)

Operations

(<https://cloud.google.com/products/operations>)

Logging (<https://cloud.google.com/logging/>)

Monitoring (<https://cloud.google.com/monitoring/>)

Think about the last time you bought something online. Chances are, you used a website to look up product information, reviewed availability. So it's no surprise that billions each year on pay-per-click (PPC) ads that show up in search results.

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Behind the scenes, PPC managers juggle many moving parts, from ad management to keyword mining, to deliver successful search campaigns. The PPC Samurai (<https://ppcsamurai.com/>) workflow management platform, powered by Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>), helps digital agencies work efficiently by automating routine tasks such as account and budget management in minutes.

“Automation is the secret sauce for PPC management. By freeing up time from putting out fires, digital agencies can focus on client relationships and industry knowledge to grow the business,” says Tom Herbert-Doyle, Head of Marketing at PPC Samurai. “Migrating to Google

Cloud gives users a snappier response time when they access our application or run queries.”

Using PPC Samurai, digital marketers can build and execute PPC workflows without requiring coding skills. PPC Samurai integrates ad performance data from search engines such as Google Ads (<https://ads.google.com>) into the client dashboard with the help of Cloud SQL (/sql). As a result, account managers can easily prioritize what they need to do for campaign success for each client by looking at outstanding actions on the dashboard.

PPC Samurai worked with Google Cloud Managed Service Provider DoiT International (<https://www.doit-intl.com/>) for advice and guidance, particularly in the CloudSQL migration. “DoiT helped us solve several issues relating to sizing and migrating instances. Whenever we had issues come up, the team would be quick to respond. Having a support partner on hand gives us the added confidence to resolve critical issues quickly,” says Dean Povey, Chief Technology Officer at PPC Samurai. The PPC Samurai team also leverages DoiT’s advice in the planning and design phases when making architecture decisions.



From a development standpoint, Google Cloud helps PPC Samurai to scale up services more quickly.

Povey adds that he can provision compute resources as needed on Google Cloud to build new features such as an inline action menu in the dashboard instead of waiting two weeks for a server from the legacy data center.

“Additionally, rolling deployment on [Google Kubernetes Engine](#) (/kubernetes-engine) (GKE) helps us move from approximately five-minute downtime per upgrade to zero downtime, which means the application is available to customers more than 99.95% of the time.”

PPC Samurai hosts its web application backend on GKE and stores 5 TB of ad performance data such as clicks and impressions on the Cloud SQL database.

## **Managing app performance for customers**

In its early stage, PPC Samurai participated in the [Google Cloud for Startups](#) (/startup) program and used Google Cloud credits to deploy a test cluster for its US region. Results from the two-week trial convinced Povey that Google Cloud is the right cloud platform for PPC Samurai.

“From its user interface to API support, Google Cloud offers a great consistent experience compared to other cloud providers,” says Povey. “For example, we can manage all aspects of our Google Cloud workloads on the [Google Cloud console](#)

(/cloud-console), instead of a different login for each service.”

Povey adds that error reporting and log monitoring in the operations suite (/products/operations) was a welcomed improvement to prevent downtime for users. PPC Samurai uses Google Cloud Marketplace (/marketplace) to proactively detect bugs and create alerting policies so that the system is always running smoothly. In addition, the team uses Cloud Logging (/logging) as a health check for low memory states and restarts clusters that are consuming too much resources without affecting operations.

Povey adds, “Just as PPC Samurai helps PPC experts save time with automated workflows, Google Cloud simplifies our cloud management workflows with Cloud Logging and Cloud Monitoring, so we can spend time resolving business-critical issues.”

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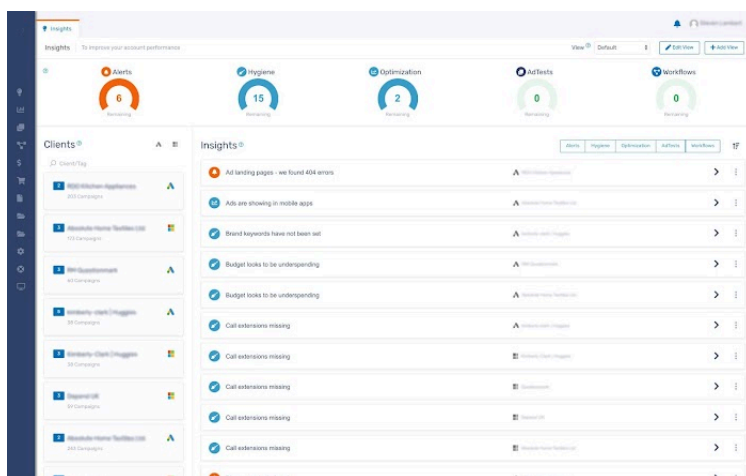
—Dean Povey, Chief  
Technology Officer, PPC  
Samurai

## **Keeping data up to date for ad performance insights**

Ad performance insights helps digital marketers track how each search campaign is performing and what needs to be improved to meet client goals. With digital agencies managing tens and thousands of accounts, it has never been more important to have an intuitive platform to work with. Setting up a workflow on PPC Samurai is as simple as a few clicks. However, on the backend, each workflow may require multiple query activities.

A workflow to reduce wasted ad spend, for example, requires calculating the ratio of cost of converting data versus non-converting data based on conversion metrics such as ad group cost, keyword cost, or search query cost. This is a laborious task if done manually.

“We lacked scalable storage in our legacy environment. As a result, we frequently ran out of disk space, which meant risking critical downtime. We also did not have great visibility into database-related performance issues for our app users,” says Povey. “On Cloud SQL, we use Insights to identify performance issues and operate as efficiently as possible. This has allowed us to halve the number of CPUs required in our Cloud SQL instances.”



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We’re looking to  
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—Dean Povey, Chief  
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## AI takes marketing automation to the next level

With the customer in mind, PPC Samurai plans to revamp its architecture by the end of 2021 as a single-page application, from its current server-side rendered application to improve page load. This is to welcome a broader audience by making it easier for advertisers to use without losing any of the features required by power user agencies. By leveraging GKE, PPC Samurai can take advantage of autoscaling to pause and resume workloads according to demand.

Moving forward, PPC Samurai is eyeing AI and machine learning capabilities in Google Cloud to evolve its marketing automation platform.

“Google Cloud’s strategy to improve business processes with automation sits well with our mission to combine human intelligence with marketing automation,” says Povey. “We’re looking to build PPC forecasts and predictions with [Google Cloud AI \(/products/ai\)](#) tools so digital marketers can achieve better results for their search campaigns.”